Kami
A card game with Mahjong roots
Playable with standard playing cards.
COMPLETE RULES
V6
A game by
Angelo Curatolo
— in collaboration with ChatGPT
Illustrations and layout
by ChatGPT

**Kami** is inspired by **Riichi Mahjong** (Japanese Mahjong).

It uses standard playing cards and simplifies some of Mahjong's rules to make the game more accessible.

## Welcome to the Forest of Kami.

Perhaps you'll become a **Kamishi** (a Kami player).

# KAMI

*A card game with Mahjong roots*

A game by Angelo Curatolo — in collaboration with ChatGPT
For 2 or 4 players — Ages 10 and up
Short game 30–40 minutes / Long game 60–80 minutes
Inspired by Riichi Mahjong (Japanese Mahjong)

**Kami 紙 means “paper” in Japanese**
The name refers to the use of standard playing cards rather than traditional Mahjong tiles. Kami draws inspiration from Riichi Mahjong, adapting and simplifying some of its mechanics.

Kami was designed primarily for four players. The two-player variant, along with other variants, is presented at the end of this rulebook. These rules may continue to evolve following further playtesting.

Your feedback is welcome: chroniqludiq@gmail.com

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To my wife Brigitte, for her unwavering patience.
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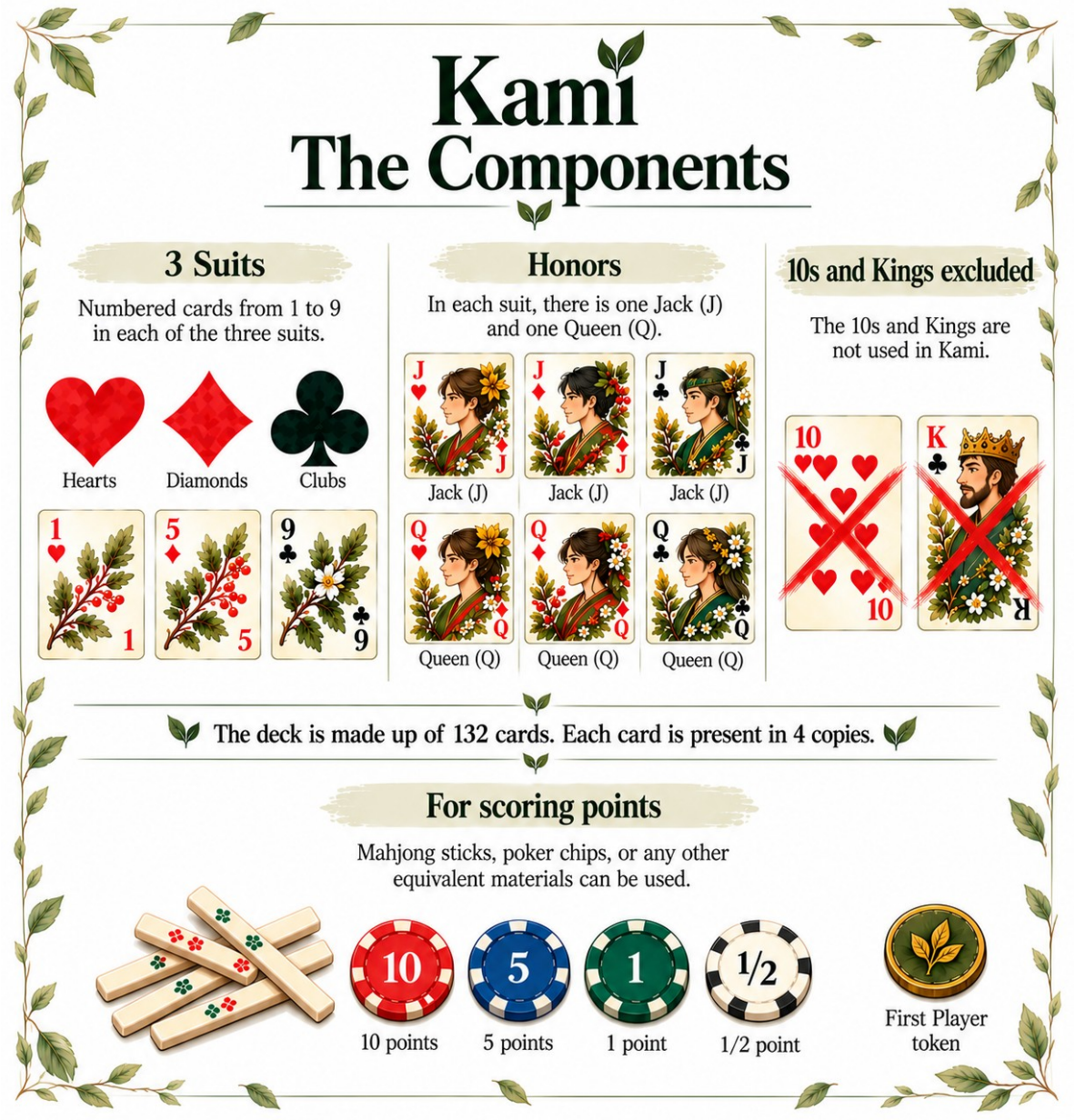
To Cléo and Zorro, for their unwavering composure.

# Objective of the Game

The objective of Kami is to form a winning 11-card Hand, consisting of three Sequences and/or Triplets and one Pair. This Hand must meet the requirements of at least one Key to earn Victory Points at the expense of the other players.



# KAMI V6 — EQUIPMENT AND SETUP

## Equipment

**The cards:** Take four standard 52-card decks, without Jokers. From each deck, remove all Spades (♠), then the 10s and Kings from the three remaining suits: Hearts (♥), Diamonds (♦), and Clubs (♣). You will have 132 cards divided into three suits, with four copies of each card.

**The suits:** Each suit contains numbered cards from 1 to 9 (Aces count as 1). These cards can form Sequences, Triplets, and Pairs. The cards numbered 1 and 9 in each suit are called Terminals.

**Honor cards:** Jacks (J) and Queens (Q). Each Honor card belongs to a suit (♥, ♦, or ♣). Honor cards can form Triplets and Pairs, but never Sequences. Their suit also matters for the requirements of certain Keys.

**What you need:** Four standard decks of cards, 60 Victory Point tokens (4 worth 10 points, 8 worth 5 points, 32 worth 1 point, and 16 worth ½ point), and a First Player token. Mahjong scoring sticks, poker chips, or other suitable tokens can be used.

## Setup

**Choosing the Keys:** Before starting the game, players agree on which Key category to play with: Common, Uncommon, Rare, or Mythic.

Each category includes all Keys from the preceding categories. For example, playing with Rare Keys also allows Common and Uncommon Keys.

The Keys in each category are presented in the Key List later in this rulebook.

**Starting capital:** Each player receives the tokens corresponding to the chosen category.

| Tokens per player | Common | Uncommon | Rare | Mythic |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **10 points** | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 |
| **5 points** | 0 | 1 | 2 | 1 |
| **1 point** | 8 | 8 | 8 | 8 |
| **½ point** | 4 | 4 | 4 | 4 |
| **Total capital** | 10 | 15 | 20 | 25 |

**Exchanging tokens:** Players may exchange tokens of equal total value with one another at any time to make payments easier. These exchanges do not change their capital.

**First Player:** Players freely choose who will start the game and give that player the First Player token.

**Shuffling the cards:** Players spread all 132 cards face down on the table and mix them together by hand, as in Mahjong, to shuffle them thoroughly.

**The Dead Leaves Pile:** Once the cards have been shuffled, the First Player randomly removes 10 cards without looking at them and sets them aside, face down. These cards form the Dead Leaves Pile and will not be used during this round.

**The Forest of Kami:** Using the remaining 122 cards, form four face-down draw piles, as close in size as possible, and arrange them in a cross at the center of the table. Together, they form the Forest of Kami, referred to simply as “the Forest” throughout the rest of the rules.

# KAMI V6 — SETUP AND DEALING

**Personal discard area:** Each player has a space for their discarded cards in front of the Forest draw pile facing them. Discarded cards remain visible to all players.

**Placing the Dead Leaves Pile:** The First Player places the Dead Leaves Pile in the center of the four draw piles of the Forest of Kami.

**Trump Indicator:** The First Player turns over the top card of the Dead Leaves Pile and leaves it face up on top of the pile. This card becomes the Trump Indicator for the entire round.

## Dealing the cards

Starting with the player in first position, followed by the players in positions 2, 3, and 4, each player draws 4 cards, one from each of the four draw piles, starting with the pile in front of them and continuing clockwise.

Repeat this process a second time. Finally, each player draws two more cards: one from the pile in front of them and one from the pile to their left.

Each player now has ten cards in hand. Keep them hidden from the other players.

Each player places their point tokens to their left.

**You are now ready to play!**

# KAMI V6 — THE TRUMP CARD AND THE HAND

At the beginning of each round, the Trump Indicator determines which card becomes the Trump Card for the entire round.

## Numbered Cards

**Rule:** the Trump Card is the card immediately above the Trump Indicator in the same suit.

6♥ → 7♥

*Trump Indicator* *Trump Card*

**Exception:** if the Trump Indicator is a 9, the Trump Card is the 1 (Ace) of the same suit.

## Honour Cards

**Rule:** the Trump Card keeps the same rank (Jack or Queen), but changes suit according to the following order:

**Hearts (♥) → Diamonds (♦) → Clubs (♣) → Hearts (♥)**

Q♥ → Q♦

*Trump Indicator* *Trump Card*

## Bonus Points

**Each Trump Card in the winning Hand scores 1 additional Victory Point.**

Example: if the Trump Card is 7♥ and the winning Hand contains two 7♥ cards, it scores 2 additional points from Trump Cards.

## The Hand

Each player starts the round with 10 cards in hand. To win, they must complete their Hand with an 11th card.

**A winning Hand normally consists of four elements:**

Three elements of 3 cards, each forming a Sequence or a Triplet, and one element of 2 cards, forming a Pair.

| 3♥ 4♥ 5♥ | 7♣ 7♣ 7♣ | 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ | Q♥ Q♥ |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sequence | Triplet | Sequence | Pair |

**3 elements of 3 cards + 1 Pair = 11 cards**

**Sequence:** three consecutive numbered cards of the same suit.

**Triplet:** three identical cards.

**Pair:** two identical cards.

Honour Cards (Jacks and Queens) can form Triplets and Pairs, but never Sequences.

## The Key

To be a winning Hand, it must also meet the conditions of at least one Key, presented in the List of Keys later in this rulebook.

Certain special Keys, however, allow a Hand to win with a different structure.

# Kami 紙

## The Winning Hand

In Kami, a **Winning Hand** is made up of 11 cards, organized as:

**3 × 3** + **1 × 2**

Three sets of 3 cards — One pair of 2 cards

### Example of a Winning Hand (11 cards)

**Sequence**
Three consecutive numbers *in the* same suit.

**Triplet**
Three identical cards.

**Sequence**
Three consecutive numbers *in the* same suit.

**Pair**
Two identical cards.

### The 11th Card

The 11th card, which completes the Winning Hand, can be:

**drawn** from the Forest (the draw pile), **or** **captured** from an opponent (according to the rules explained later).

### Key Points

- A total of **11 cards**: 3 sets of 3 cards and 1 pair of 2 cards.
- The hand must contain **at least one Key** (a recognized combination) to be a winning hand.
- The **3 × 3 + 1 × 2** structure is the standard one. Some Keys may be exceptions (e.g., The Cascade, The Nine Gates, etc.).

# KAMI V6 — TURN OF PLAY

## How a Turn Works

Players take turns clockwise, starting with the First Player.

On their turn, a player performs two actions, in this order:

### 1. Draw a Card

The player draws one card from the Forest and adds it to their Hand. They now temporarily hold 11 cards.

### 2. Discard a Card

If they have not completed a winning Hand, the player chooses one card from their Hand and places it face up in their Personal Discard Area. They now have 10 cards in their Hand again.

Play then passes to the player on their left.

## Drawing Order in the Forest

At the beginning of the round, players draw from the pile in front of the First Player. When that pile is exhausted, they continue with the next pile clockwise, and so on.

### Tip — Mark the Current Draw Pile

Place a token on the next draw pile clockwise: it shows that players must draw from the preceding pile. When that pile is empty, move the token one pile clockwise. This token is optional and separate from the First Player token.

## Personal Discard Area

Each player has their own Personal Discard Area in front of them. Discarded cards remain face up and visible to all players.

To save space on the table, they may be arranged in rows of six cards, slightly overlapping.

*Example of a personal discard area: cards remain visible in slightly overlapping rows of six.*

## KAMI V6 — CAPTURE AND THE “I TAKE IT!” CALL

### When Can You Capture a Card?

When a player discards a card, another player may capture it to complete a Triplet or a Sequence. To do so, they call “I Take It!”

Players must give their opponents a brief moment to react before drawing. If a player draws too quickly, a call made immediately afterward is still valid; the drawn card is returned to the Forest.

### Which Cards Can Be Captured?

Triplet — A card discarded by any opponent may be captured to complete a Triplet.

Sequence — A card may be captured to complete a Sequence only if it was discarded by the player on your right.

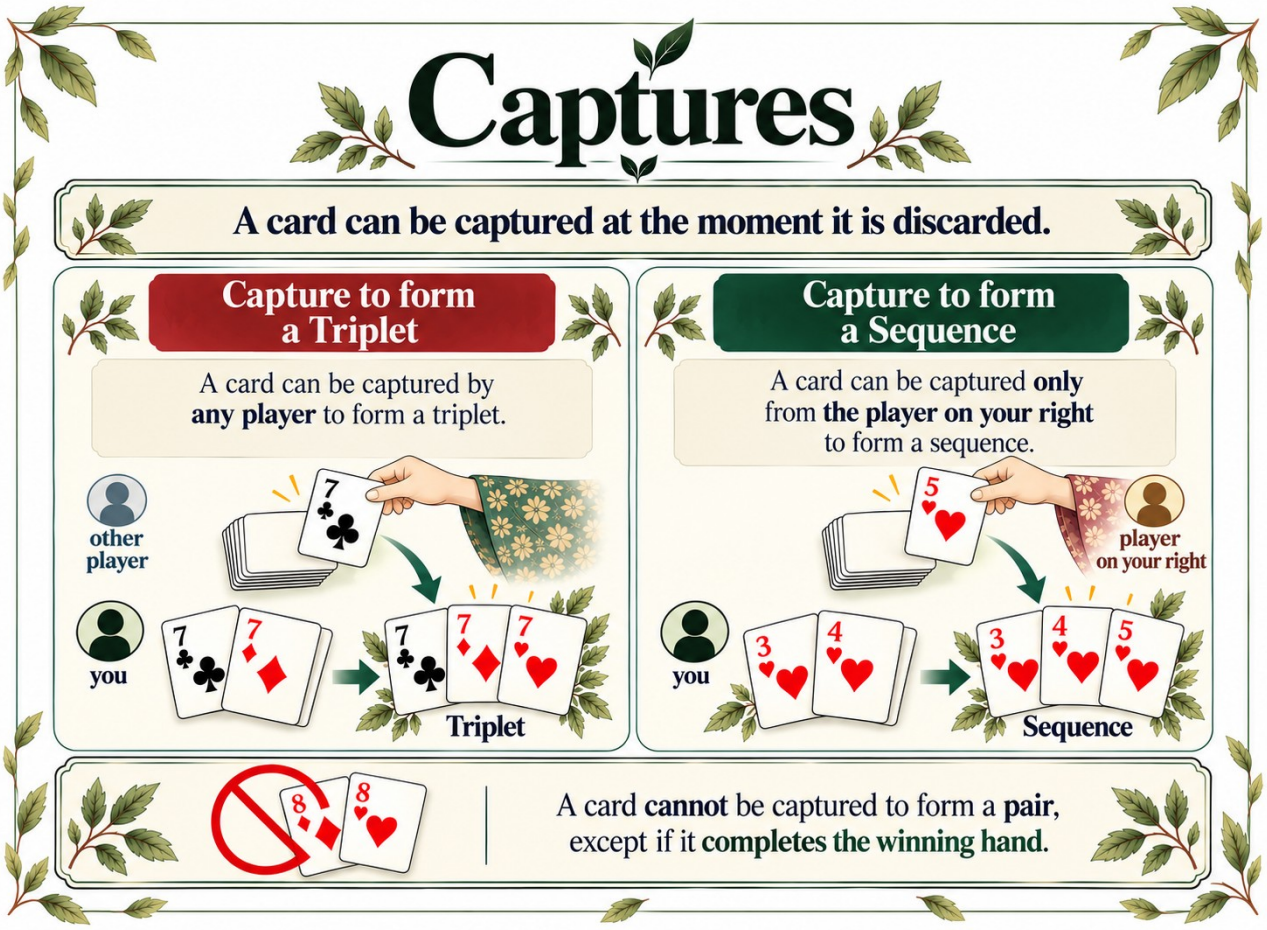
Pair — A discarded card cannot be captured to form a Pair unless it completes a winning Hand.

### If Several Players Want the Same Card

Priority: 1. A winning Hand; 2. Triplet before Sequence; 3. if tied, the player closest clockwise to the player who discarded.

### After the Capture

The capturing player reveals the two cards from their Hand needed to complete the Triplet or Sequence, adds the captured card, and places all three face up to their right. They then discard one card without drawing. Play passes to the player on their left, so some players may lose their turn.



# KAMI V6 — CLOSED HAND, OPEN HAND, WAITING AND MIRROR

### Closed Hand and Open Hand

A Hand is closed as long as the player has not captured a card to form a Sequence or a Triplet.

When a player captures a card and reveals a Sequence or a Triplet, their Hand becomes open. An open Hand remains open until the end of the round, even if the player makes no further captures.

This distinction matters because some Keys require a closed Hand or award more points when completed with a closed Hand.

### Waiting

A player is Waiting when they need just one more card to complete a winning Hand.

Single Wait — Only one card can complete the Hand.

Double Wait — Two different cards can complete the Hand.

A waiting card may be obtained by drawing or by capture, subject to the applicable rules.

### Mirror

A player is in Mirror if at least one of the cards that could complete their Hand appears in their own discards. This applies to both a Single Wait and a Double Wait.

While in Mirror, the player cannot win by capturing any of their waiting cards. They can still win by drawing a card that completes their Hand and continue playing normally.

Example — A player is waiting for the 3 or 6 of Hearts. If the 3 of Hearts is already in their own discards, they are in Mirror. They cannot win by capturing either the 3 or the 6 of Hearts, but they can still win by drawing either card.

# KAMI V6 — THE KAMI

## The Kami Bet

“Kami” is an optional bet that allows a Kamishi (player) to stake 1 point on their own victory when they are Waiting and their Hand is closed.

To declare “Kami”, the player must wait until the end of their turn, after discarding a card.

They then announce “Kami!”, take a 1-point token from their reserve and place it in front of them. (An opponent may win this token if that opponent wins the round.)

Several players may declare “Kami” during the same round.

## Condition for Declaring Kami

Kami may be declared only if, at the moment of declaration, at least one card that could complete the Hand is absent from all players’ discards, including the declaring player’s own discards.

Single Wait — The waiting card must be absent from all players’ discards.

Double Wait — At least one of the two waiting cards must be absent from all players’ discards.

The player must check this condition themselves, in secret, before declaring “Kami”, without revealing their Hand or their waiting cards.

## After the Declaration

After declaring “Kami”, the player may no longer change their Hand or their waiting cards.

They may no longer capture a card to form a Sequence or a Triplet: their Hand must remain closed.

On each of their turns, they draw as usual. If the drawn card does not let them win, they must discard that same card.

They may also win by capturing a waiting card discarded by any opponent, provided they respect the Mirror rule.

## Why Kami Is Enough

Kami is itself a Key. A Kamishi who has declared “Kami” can therefore win the round by completing a winning Hand, even if that Hand contains no other Key.

## Kami at a Glance

**Waiting → Discard → Declare “Kami!” and stake 1 point → Hand stays fixed until victory or the end of the round.**

# The Kami — Step by Step

**Kami is a one-point bet made while Waiting, committing the player to winning with a waiting card.**

### 1 Be Waiting

Have a closed Hand that needs just one more card to win (Single or Double Wait).

### 2 Declare “Kami!”

After discarding, declare “Kami!” and bet 1 point, provided a waiting card is absent from all discards.

### 3 Lock Your Hand

After “Kami!”, the Hand stays closed and fixed. Capture is allowed only to win immediately.

### 4 Try to Win

Win by drawing or capturing a waiting card from any opponent, subject to Mirror.

## Example

The player is waiting for the Jack of Clubs. “Kami!” is allowed because no player has discarded a Jack of Clubs.

**Hand (10 cards, closed)**

4♥ 5♥ 6♥ 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ 3♣ 4♣ 5♣ J♣

**Waiting**

J♣

**✓ Kami allowed!**

No Jack of Clubs appears in any discard. The condition is met.

**Player A — discards**

3♥ 6♣ 8♦

**Player B — discards**

2♥ 7♦ Q♣

**Player C — discards**

5♦ 8♣ 9♥

**The 1-point wager**

The player stakes 1 point and tries to win with J♣, either by drawing it or by capture.

# KAMI V6 — COMPLETING YOUR HAND AND WINNING THE ROUND

A round ends when a Kamishi (player) completes an 11-card Winning Hand and declares victory. There are two ways to win a round.

| Win by Draw — “Served!” | Win by Capture — “Thank you!” |
| --- | --- |
| When a Kamishi who is Waiting draws the card that completes their Winning Hand, they call “Served!” and reveal their Hand.<br><br>This win is possible with a Closed or Open Hand, even if the player is in Mirror. | When a Kamishi who is Waiting sees an opponent discard the card that completes their Winning Hand, they may capture it and call “Thank you!”.<br><br>The card may come from any opponent. This win is possible with a Closed or Open Hand, unless the player is in Mirror. |

Reminder — An Open Hand may win by draw (“Served!”) or by capture (“Thank you!”), but can never declare Kami.

## Winning takes priority

Capturing a card to win the round always takes priority over capturing a card to form a Sequence or a Triplet.

Simultaneous wins — If several Kamishi call “Thank you!” on the same discarded card, only the player closest to the discarder in clockwise order wins the round.

## Checking the Winning Hand

The winning Kamishi reveals their Hand. The players check that the complete Hand, including any previously exposed combinations, meets the winning conditions and contains at least one Key.

A Kami declared in accordance with the rules is itself a Key: no other Key is required.

The round then concludes with the calculation of the Winning Hand’s value, followed by payment of points.

# KAMI V6 — POINT PAYMENT

Once the Winning Hand has been verified, its full value is calculated, including any applicable bonuses. The winning Kamishi then receives these Victory Points according to how the Round was won.

### “Served!” — Self-draw win

The three opponents share the payment as evenly as possible, in steps of ½ point.

Each opponent first pays the same amount. Any extra ½ or 1 point is then paid clockwise, starting with the opponent seated to the winner’s left.

### “Thank you!” — Win on a discard

The opponent who discarded the winning card alone pays the full value of the Hand.

The other two opponents pay nothing.

### Illustrated example — Winning Hand worth 5 points

**Other “Served!” examples** — For a Hand worth 2 points, the first opponent pays 1 point and the other two pay ½ point each. For a Hand worth 1 point, the first two opponents each pay ½ point; the third pays nothing.

# KAMI V6 — SPECIAL CASES

Certain situations affect how points are calculated or awarded. The following rules complement those governing Kami and point payments.

## The Under Trump Card

Each ordinary Trump Card in the Winning Hand still scores 1 additional point (see “The Trump Card”).

The Under Trump Card is a reward for a Kamishi who succeeds in their Kami bet: they must have declared “Kami!” and then won the round. They reveal a card that was face down in the Dead Leaves Pile. This becomes the Under Trump Indicator. The Under Trump Card is determined using the same rules as the ordinary Trump Card.

Each Under Trump Card in the Winning Hand scores 1 additional point. This bonus is added to the ordinary Trump Card bonus and is counted before the opponents make their payments.

**Example —** The Under Trump Indicator is 3♣, so the Under Trump Card is 4♣. If the Winning Hand contains two 4♣ cards, it scores 2 additional points from this bonus.

## Kami Stakes and Carried-over Points

Each “Kami!” declaration requires a stake of 1 point, placed in front of the Kamishi who declares it. Several Kamishi may declare Kami during the same round.

- **If a Kamishi wins the round:** they collect every stake still on the table, including their own if they had declared Kami.
- **If no one wins the round:** all stakes remain on the table and carry over to the next round, until a Kamishi wins.
- **At the end of the game:** if the final round ends without a winner, any stakes still on the table are awarded to no one and are excluded from the final standings.

The stakes are awarded after point payments: they are not part of the value of the Winning Hand.

## Incorrect Winning Declaration

If a Kamishi declares “Served!” or “Thank You!” when their Hand does not meet the conditions for victory, the round is cancelled.
The Kamishi at fault pays 1 point to each of the other three Kamishi.
The round is replayed with the same First Player, after reshuffling and dealing new Hands.
Any Kami stakes remain on the table and are carried over to the replayed round.
If the penalty reduces the Kamishi’s capital to zero, the game ends immediately.

## Insufficient Points

If a Kamishi owes more points than they have, they pay all their remaining points. The unpaid amount is not created, and the winner does not receive it. After a “Served!” win, the other opponents do not make up the shortfall.

If a Kamishi finishes the round with 0 points, the game ends (see “End of the Game”).

# KAMI V6 — END OF THE ROUND AND END OF THE GAME

## End of the Round

A round ends when a Kamishi completes a Winning Hand with “Served!” or “Thank you!”, or when the Forest runs out of cards without a winner.

When the final card is drawn from the Forest, the last turn is completed as normal: the Kamishi may win with the card they have just drawn, and their final discard may still allow an opponent to win by capture. If no one wins, the round ends without a winner.

## Forest Exhausted — Waiting Points

If there is no winner, all Kamishi reveal their Hands. Kamishi who are Waiting receive points paid by those who are not Waiting, as shown in the table below:

| Waiting | Point Distribution |
|---|---|
| **None** | No points are exchanged. |
| **1 Kamishi** | Each of the other three pays 1 point to that Kamishi. |
| **2 Kamishi** | Each of the other two pays 1.5 points to a different Waiting Kamishi. Each Waiting Kamishi therefore receives 1.5 points. |
| **3 Kamishi** | The Kamishi who is not Waiting pays 1 point to each of the other three. |
| **4 Kamishi** | No points are exchanged. |

**Important —** A Kamishi who is Waiting receives Waiting Points even if they are in Mirror. If a Kamishi cannot pay the full amount, they pay only their remaining points; missing points are not created.

## Preparing the Next Round

Gather all the cards face down and shuffle them. Set aside 10 cards to form the Dead Leaves Pile, rebuild the Forest’s four draw piles, then reveal the new Trump Indicator.

Pass the First Player Token to the Kamishi on the current holder’s left. Any unclaimed Kami stakes stay on the table and carry over to the next round.

## End of the Game

- **Short Game:** each Kamishi holds First Position once (4 rounds).
- **Long Game:** each Kamishi holds First Position twice (8 rounds).
- **Early End:** if a Kamishi ends a round with 0 points after payments, the game ends immediately.

The Kamishi with the most points wins the game. If several Kamishi tie for first place, they share the victory.

If the final round ends without a winner, any Kami stakes still on the table are awarded to no one and do not count towards the final standings.

# KAMI V6 — VARIANTS

## Variant for Two Kamishi

Kami can also be played by two people. Two ghost players occupy the empty seats at the table: they have no Hand and take no turns, but each has a discard area. The usual rules apply, with the following adjustments.

## Setup

- **Positions:** the two Kamishi sit opposite each other in Positions 1 and 3; the ghost players occupy Positions 2 and 4.
- **First Player:** choose one of the Kamishi at random and give them the First Player Token.
- **Dead Leaves Pile:** set aside 20 face-down cards instead of the usual 10.

Deal 10 cards to each Kamishi using the usual method; the ghosts receive no cards. The rest of the setup is unchanged.

## Turn of Play and Ghost Discards

On their turn, a Kamishi draws a card from the Forest and discards a card from their Hand. They then draw one additional card from the Forest and place it face up in the discard area of the ghost player on their left. Ghost players' discards remain visible and count when checking the conditions for declaring Kami.

## Captures

Cards discarded by ghost players may be captured under exactly the same rules as in a four-player game: to form a Triplet, a Sequence or a Winning Hand, with the same priorities and restrictions.
After capturing a card to form a Triplet or Sequence, the Kamishi discards a card from their Hand. They then draw a card from the Forest and place it face up in the discard area of the ghost player on their left. Play continues under the usual rules.

## Point Payments

- **"Served!" — Win by Draw:** points are shared as in a four-player game. The opposing Kamishi pays their share; the Bank pays the shares of both ghosts.
- **"Thank you!" — Win by Capture:** the player responsible for the winning discard pays all the points. If the card was discarded by a ghost, the Bank pays the full amount.

## Incorrect Winning Declaration

If a Kamishi incorrectly declares "Served!" or "Thank you!", they pay 1 point to their sole opponent. All other provisions of "Incorrect Winning Declaration" (see "Special Cases") still apply.

## Round Without a Winner

If the Forest runs out of cards without a winner, after the final turn has been resolved:

- **Only one Kamishi is Waiting:** the other pays them 1 point.
- **Both Kamishi are Waiting, or neither is:** no points are exchanged.

Ghost players never receive Waiting Points.

## Game Length and End of Game

At the start of each new round, the Kamishi swap Positions 1 and 3. The First Player Token passes to the Kamishi taking Position 1.

- **Short Game:** 4 rounds, with each Kamishi holding First Position twice.
- **Long Game:** 8 rounds, with each Kamishi holding First Position four times.

# KAMI V6 — VARIANTS

## Other Variants

These variants are optional. They can be played individually or combined, even all at once. Before the game begins, the Kamishi agree on which variants to use. Unless otherwise stated, the standard Kami rules still apply.

## The Explosive Guardian

When a Triplet of Queens is formed by capturing a discarded card, reveal a new Trump Indicator from the Dead Leaves Pile.

All revealed Trump Cards remain active until the end of the round. If several Indicators point to the same Trump Card, each matching card scores the Trump bonus only once.

## The Jokers

Before the game, remove one 5 from each suit (♥, ♦ and ♣) and replace these three cards with three Jokers.

• **Value:** a Joker represents a 5 of any suit. Its suit is determined by the combination or Key in which it is used.

• **Captures and Keys:** a Joker may be captured as the 5 it represents and may be used in any Key, including the Grand Keys, provided all other conditions of those Keys are met.

• **Limits:** a Joker can never be part of a Pair. A Triplet may contain only one Joker.

• **Bonus:** each Joker in the Winning Hand scores 1 additional point. If it represents a Trump Card, it also scores the Trump bonus, which stacks with its Joker bonus.

## The Dry Stream

With this variant, the Key “The Stream” can only be completed with a Closed Hand.

# KAMI V6 — VARIANTS

## Advanced variant — Quads

This variant cannot be combined with the Explosive Guardian variant.

**This variant is intended for experienced Kamishis**, who are already familiar with the standard rules of Kami.

Inspired by Riichi Mahjong, it allows players to form Quads, adds new playing possibilities and introduces three additional Keys.

It can be combined with the other Kami variants.

## What is a Quad?

**A Quad** consists of four identical cards.

Although it contains four cards, it counts as a Triplet when forming a Winning Hand and fulfilling the conditions for Keys.

There are three types of Quad: Closed Quads, Open Quads and Added Quads.

## Closed Quad

When a Kamishi holds four identical cards in their Hand, they may announce “Quad!” during their turn, after drawing and before discarding.

They place the four cards side by side to their right, **with the two middle cards face up and the two outer cards face down.**

This arrangement shows the other Kamishis that it is a **Closed Quad.**

A Closed Quad does not turn a Closed Hand into an Open Hand.

## Open Quad

When an opponent discards a card that would let a Kamishi complete a Quad using three identical cards from their Hand, the Kamishi may announce “Quad!”.

They capture the discarded card, add it to the three identical cards in their Hand and place all four cards side by side to their right, **all face up.**

This arrangement shows the other Kamishis that it is an **Open Quad.**

Their Hand becomes Open.

The usual capture priority rules apply.

## Added Quad

When a Kamishi has an exposed Triplet and holds the fourth identical card in their Hand, they may announce “Quad!” during their turn, after drawing and before discarding.

They add this fourth card, face up, to the three cards of their exposed Triplet.

The Triplet thus becomes an **Added Quad.**

Their Hand remains Open.

## After completing a Quad

When a Kamishi completes a Quad, they immediately draw a replacement card from the remaining face-down cards in the Dead Leaves Pile.

A new Trump Indicator is then revealed by turning over another face-down card from the Dead Leaves Pile.

If the replacement card completes a Winning Hand, the Kamishi may announce “Servi!”.

Otherwise, they discard one card from their Hand, and play continues as normal.

## Advanced variant — Quads (continued)

### Quad after declaring Kami

A Kamishi who has declared “Kami!” may exceptionally form a Closed Quad, provided that:

- The card they have just drawn completes a Closed Triplet already in their Hand.
- Forming the Quad changes neither the structure of their Hand nor their Waiting Cards.

They then announce “Quad!”, expose the four cards in the usual Closed Quad arrangement, and draw a replacement card from the Dead Leaves Pile. They then reveal a new Trump Indicator by turning face up a card that is still face down in the Dead Leaves Pile.

If this card lets them win, they announce “Servi!”. Otherwise, they must discard that same card.

Their Kami declaration remains in effect.

### Quads in a Winning Hand

Although a Quad contains four cards rather than three, it still counts as a Triplet when composing a Winning Hand.

A Winning Hand contains:

- 12 cards if it includes **one Quad**.
- 13 cards if it includes **two Quads**.
- 14 cards if it includes **three Quads**.

A Kamishi may therefore complete at most three Quads in the same Winning Hand.

The usual requirements for Keys still apply.

### Quad limit

During a single Round, **a maximum of four Quads may be completed** across all Kamishis.

After the fourth Quad is completed, the Round continues as normal, but no further Quad may be declared.

### Quads and Jokers

When the Joker variant is used, a Joker may stand in for a 5 to form a Quad.

That Quad then consists of **three natural 5s of the same suit and one Joker.**

A Quad may contain no more than one Joker.

All other Joker rules still apply.

### The three new Keys

### The Four-Leaf Clover — 2 Points · O/C · +1 if Closed

Win the Round using the replacement card drawn from the Dead Leaves Pile after completing a Quad.

The Kamishi then announces “Servi!”.

### The Windblown Leaf — 3 Points · O/C · +1 if Closed

When a Kamishi declares an Added Quad, an opponent may capture the fourth card if it completes their Winning Hand.

They then announce “Merci!” and win the Round.

The Added Quad is not completed. The Kamishi who attempted it pays the Points of the Winning Hand. No new Trump Indicator is revealed.

### The Great Boughs — 15 Points · O/C · +1 if Closed

Complete three Quads in the same Winning Hand.

Those Quads may be Closed, Open or Added.

*ChatGPT*

Kami
The Keys

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Two Important Concepts

Before discovering the Keys of Kami, it is important to understand two concepts: **the Turn Jack** and **Position**.

These two concepts play a role in completing certain Keys and are therefore explained here first.

## The Turn Jack

The Turn Jack is the Jack of the same suit (♥, ♦ or ♣) as **the initial Trump Indicator**, revealed at the start of the round. It remains unchanged until the end of that round.

| Initial Trump Indicator | | Turn Jack |
|---|---|---|
| 6♥ | → | J♥ |

In this example, the Trump Card is **7**♥: the Trump Card and the Turn Jack are not the same thing.

**Exception:** if the initial Trump Indicator is itself a Jack, there is **no Turn Jack** for that round.

Additional Trump Indicators, including those revealed by **The Explosive Guardian**, never change the Turn Jack.

## The Position

In each round, the Kamishi holding the First Player token is in **Position 1**. The others occupy **Positions 2, 3 and 4**, clockwise.

To complete the “Position” Key, the Kamishi must hold a **Triplet matching the number of their Position**.

| Position 1 | Position 2 | Position 3 | Position 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1♥ 1♥ 1♥ | 2♦ 2♦ 2♦ | 3♣ 3♣ 3♣ | 4♥ 4♥ 4♥ |

The Triplet may use **Hearts**, **Diamonds** or **Clubs**, but its three cards must be **identical**.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Key Categories

In Kami, Keys are divided into four categories, allowing players to gradually discover the full richness of the game. Each category gives access to all Keys from the preceding categories.

## Common

The most accessible Keys, which help players discover Kami's fundamental mechanics and win their first rounds.

## Uncommon

Generally more demanding combinations that introduce new possibilities and expand the strategic choices available to Kamishis.

## Rare

Remarkable combinations, often harder to achieve, that require a good understanding of the game and sometimes a particular way of building the Hand.

## Mythic

Exceptional combinations, among the most prestigious in Kami. Completing one is a memorable achievement for a Kamishi.

## The Grand Keys

Certain Keys, among the Rare and Mythic categories, stand out for their exceptional nature. They are called the **Grand Keys**. Completing them requires skill, but also a measure of luck. Achieving a Grand Key is a true source of pride for a Kamishi.

This distinction highlights their prestige: **it does not form a fifth category**.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Common Keys

**O/C:** open or closed · **C:** closed only · **O:** open only.
**Stacking:** Keys can be combined; if one Key is contained within a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.

### The Good Fairy — 1 pt · C

Draw the winning card.

**2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 7♦ 7♦ 7♦ · 9♥ 9♥**

The second 9♥ is drawn to win. Closed Hand.

### The Little Pebbles — 1 pt · O/C

A Triplet of Queens, of the Turn Jack, or matching your Position. Eligible Triplets stack; no Closed Hand bonus.

**Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 5♥ 5♥**

Initial Trump Indicator 6♣ → Turn Jack J♣: two eligible Triplets = 2 pts.

### The Stream — 1 pt · O/C

Only numbered cards from 2 to 8; no Closed Hand bonus.

**2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ · 2♥ 2♥**

No 1s, 9s, Jacks or Queens.

### The Little Path — 1 pt · O/C · +1 if closed

Two identical Sequences.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♦ 4♦ 4♦ · J♣ J♣**

Two identical 1♥–2♥–3♥ Sequences.

### The Two Oaks — 1 pt · O/C · +1 if closed

Two Triplets of the same number in two different suits.

**3♥ 3♥ 3♥ · 3♣ 3♣ 3♣ · 4♦ 5♦ 6♦ · J♣ J♣**

Two Triplets of 3s: one in Hearts and one in Clubs.

### The Kami — 2 pts · C

Declare Kami while Waiting and stake 1 point. At least one winning card must be absent from every discard pile.

**3♥ 4♥ 5♥ · 6♣ 7♣ 8♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · 9♦ 9♦**

A 9♦ absent from all discard piles is awaited; it is drawn after the declaration.

### The Grove of Oaks — 2 pts · O

Three Triplets and one Pair.

**2♥ 2♥ 2♥ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · J♥ J♥**

All three 3-card groups are Triplets; Open Hand.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Winning Hand Scoring Examples

Four situations show how to add up Keys and Trump bonuses. Each Winning Hand has 11 cards: three groups of three and one Pair.

### Example 1 — One Key

**2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ · 2♥ 2♥**

The second 2♥ is captured to win ("Thank you!"). Indicator: 8♥ → Trump Card: 9♥, not in the Hand.

**Scoring:** The Stream 1 pt

**TOTAL: 1 point**

---

### Example 2 — Two Keys

**3♥ 4♥ 5♥ · 6♣ 7♣ 8♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · 9♦ 9♦**

The Kamishi declares Kami, stakes 1 pt and draws the second 9♦ ("Served!"). That 9♦ was absent from all discard piles.

**Scoring:** The Kami 2 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 3 points**

Initial Indicator: 1♥ → Trump Card 2♥; Under Trump Indicator: 3♣ → 4♣. Neither Trump Card is in the Hand.

---

### Example 3 — Three Keys

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♦ 4♦ 4♦ · J♣ J♣**

Kamishi in Position 1, Closed Hand. Kami is declared with a 1-point stake; the second J♣, absent from discard piles, is drawn ("Served!").

**Scoring:** The Little Path 1 pt + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Kami 2 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 5 points**

Initial Indicator: 7♥ → Trump Card 8♥; Under Trump Indicator: 5♣ → 6♣. Neither Trump Card is in the Hand.

---

### Example 4 — Three Keys and Trump Cards

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♦ 4♦ 4♦ · J♣ J♣**

Same Closed Hand and Position 1 as Example 3. Indicator: 3♦ → Trump Card: 4♦. The Hand contains three 4♦.

**Scoring:** The Little Path 1 pt + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Kami 2 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt + Three 4♦ (Trump Cards) 3 pts

**TOTAL: 8 points**

Under Trump Indicator: 5♣ → Under Trump Card 6♣, absent from the Hand (+0 pts).

**Kami stakes:** stakes collected by the winner are awarded after point payments and do not count toward the Winning Hand's value.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Uncommon Keys

**O/C:** open or closed · **C:** closed only · **O:** open only.
**Stacking:** Keys can be combined; if one Key is contained within a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.

### The River — 1 pt · C

Sequences only, a two-sided wait, and an ordinary Pair.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ · 8♣ 8♣**

Before winning, 2♥ 3♥ could be completed by 1♥ or 4♥. The 1♥ completes the Sequence.

### The Two Maples — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Two concealed Triplets; the rest of the Hand may be open.

**3♥ 3♥ 3♥ · 7♣ 7♣ 7♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 9♥ 9♥**

The 3♥ and 7♣ Triplets are concealed; the Sequence may be open.

### The Forest Edge — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Every Sequence, Triplet and Pair contains a Terminal or an Honor card.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · 9♣ 9♣**

Each group contains a 1, a 9, or an Honor card.

### The Clearing — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

All numbered cards belong to one suit; Honor cards may belong to any suit.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 7♥ 8♥ 9♥ · Q♦ Q♦ Q♦ · 5♥ 5♥**

All numbered cards are Hearts; the Queen Triplet may be Diamonds.

### The Echoes — 3 pts · C

Five Pairs plus one card identical to a card in one of those Pairs.

**1♥ 1♥ · J♣ J♣ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 9♦ 9♦ · 6♥ 6♥**

Special structure: five Pairs, one of which receives a third card (5♣).

### The Assembly — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only Terminals or Honor cards.

**1♦ 1♦ 1♦ · 9♣ 9♣ 9♣ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · Q♥ Q♥**

Every card is a 1, a 9, a Jack or a Queen.

### The Winding Path — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

The same Sequence in all three suits.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 4♣ 4♣**

The 1–2–3 Sequence appears in Hearts, Clubs and Diamonds.

### The Long Path — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Two identical Sequences, plus the same Sequence in another suit.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 4♣**

Includes The Little Path: only The Long Path scores.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Uncommon Keys — Examples and Special Cases

Four Winning Hands illustrate special requirements and ways to combine these Keys with Common Keys.

### Example 1 — The River: Two-Sided Wait

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ · 8♣ 8♣**

Before winning, 2♥ 3♥ could be completed by 1♥ or 4♥. The 1♥ is captured (“Thank you!”); the Hand is closed.

Calculation: The River 1 pt

**TOTAL: 1 point**

Indicator: 9♦ → Trump Card 1♦, absent from the Hand.

---

### Example 2 — The Two Maples: Concealed Triplets and Stacking

**3♥ 3♥ 3♥ · 7♣ 7♣ 7♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 9♥ 9♥**

The 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ Sequence is open; both Triplets remain concealed. In Position 3, the Kamishi captures the second 9♥ (“Thank you!”).

Calculation: The Two Maples 2 pts + The Little Pebbles (3♥ Triplet) 1 pt

**TOTAL: 3 points**

No Closed Hand bonus: the Hand is open. Indicator: 9♦ → Trump Card 1♦, absent.

---

### Example 3 — The Echoes: A Special Winning Hand

**1♥ 1♥ · J♣ J♣ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 9♦ 9♦ · 6♥ 6♥**

Closed Hand: five Pairs plus an extra 5♣. The second 6♥ is drawn (“Served!”).

Calculation: The Echoes 3 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 4 points**

The Echoes are an exception to the usual three groups of three plus one Pair. Indicator: 2♦ → Trump Card 3♦, absent.

---

### Example 4 — The Long Path: Stacking and Included Keys

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 4♣**

Closed Hand; the second 4♣ is drawn (“Served!”). The Little Path is included within The Long Path.

Calculation: The Long Path 3 pts + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 5 points**

The Little Path scores no additional points. Indicator: 8♦ → Trump Card 9♦, absent.

**Note:** The Echoes have a special Winning Hand structure: five Pairs plus one extra card identical to a card in one of those Pairs.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Rare Keys

**O/C:** open or closed · **C:** closed only · **O:** open only.
**Stacking:** Keys can be combined; if one Key is contained within a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.

### The Great Road — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Cards 1 through 9 of a single suit, plus any Pair.

**1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 4♦ 5♦ 6♦ · 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ · 5♥ 5♥**

All nine numbered Diamonds are present; the Pair may be of any suit.

### The Little Wanderer — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Two Triplets of Jacks; the rest of the Hand is unrestricted.

**J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 7♥ 7♥**

Two Jack Triplets, one in Hearts and one in Clubs.

### The Little Guardian — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Two Triplets of Queens; the rest of the Hand is unrestricted.

**Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 7♥ 7♥**

Two Queen Triplets, one in Hearts and one in Clubs.

### The Heart Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only numbered Heart cards, with no Honors.

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 5♥ 5♥ 5♥ · 7♥ 8♥ 9♥ · 4♥ 4♥**

Every card is numbered and belongs to Hearts.

### The Silver Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only numbered Diamond cards, with no Honors.

**1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 5♦ 5♦ 5♦ · 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ · 4♦ 4♦**

Every card is numbered and belongs to Diamonds.

### The Earth Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only numbered Club cards, with no Honors.

**1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · 4♣ 4♣**

Every card is numbered and belongs to Clubs.

### The Grove of Maples — 6 pts · C

Three concealed Triplets.

**2♥ 2♥ 2♥ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · J♥ J♥**

Grand Key: all three Triplets are concealed; the Pair is unrestricted.

### The Forest of Kami — 7 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

One Sequence; one concealed numbered Triplet; an Honor Triplet and a Pair of the other Honor (different suits). All three suits must appear.

**2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 5♦ 5♦ 5♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · Q♥ Q♥**

Grand Key: the 5♦ Triplet is concealed; all three suits and both Honors are present.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Rare Keys — Examples and Grand Keys

Four Winning Hands illustrate special requirements, bonuses and our first Grand Keys.

### Example 1 — The Great Road: Nine Cards of One Suit

**1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 4♦ 5♦ 6♦ · 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ · 5♥ 5♥**

Open Hand; the second 5♥ is captured (“Thank you!”). Cards 1 through 9 are all Diamonds; the Pair may belong to another suit.

**Calculation: The Great Road 3 pts**

**TOTAL: 3 points**

No Closed Hand bonus. Indicator: 6♣ → Trump Card 7♣, absent from the Hand.

---

### Example 2 — The Heart Key: Bonus and Included Key

**1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 5♥ 5♥ 5♥ · 7♥ 8♥ 9♥ · 4♥ 4♥**

Closed Hand; the second 4♥ is drawn (“Served!”). Every card is numbered and belongs to Hearts.

**Calculation: The Heart Key 5 pts + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Good Fairy 1 pt**

**TOTAL: 7 points**

The Clearing is included and does not score. Indicator: 8♦ → Trump Card 9♦, absent.

---

### Example 3 — The Grove of Maples: Three Concealed Triplets

**2♥ 2♥ 2♥ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · J♥ J♥**

Entirely closed Hand, in Position 1. The second J♥ is drawn (“Served!”). All three Triplets are concealed.

**Calculation: The Grove of Maples 6 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt**

**TOTAL: 7 points**

The Two Maples is included; no Closed Hand bonus for this C-only Key. Indicator: 9♣ → Trump Card 1♣, absent.

---

### Example 4 — The Forest of Kami: Three Suits

**2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 5♦ 5♦ 5♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · Q♥ Q♥**

The Sequence is open; the 5♦ Triplet remains concealed. The Jack Triplet and Queen Pair are in different suits.

**Calculation: The Forest of Kami 7 pts**

**TOTAL: 7 points**

All three suits are present. Open Hand, with no Closed Hand bonus. Indicator: 8♦ → Trump Card 9♦, absent.

**Reminder:** A Key contained within a stronger Key does not score again. A C-only Key does not automatically receive a Closed Hand bonus.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Mythic Keys

**All seven Mythic Keys are Grand Keys.**

**O/C:** open or closed · **C:** closed only · **O:** open only.

**Stacking:** Keys can be combined; if one Key is contained within a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.

### The Great Wanderer — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

One Triplet of each Jack.

**J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 5♥ 5♥**

The Jacks of all three suits each form a Triplet; the Pair is unrestricted.

### The Kodama Path — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only cards numbered 1 or 9, with no Honors.

**1♥ 1♥ 1♥ · 9♦ 9♦ 9♦ · 9♣ 9♣ 9♣ · 1♣ 1♣**

Every card is a Terminal: a 1 or a 9.

### The Sanctuary — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only Honors.

**Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · Q♥ Q♥**

All eleven cards are Jacks or Queens.

### The Elders' Circle — 10 pts · C

Ten different cards among the twelve Terminals and Honors, plus one duplicate.

**Q♣ Q♣ · J♣ · 1♥ · 9♥ · 1♦ · 9♦ · Q♥ · J♥ · 1♣ · 9♣**

Exceptional Hand: ten different cards and an eleventh matching one of them.

### The Great Guardian — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

One Triplet of each Queen.

**Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · Q♦ Q♦ Q♦ · Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · 5♥ 5♥**

The Queens of all three suits each form a Triplet; the Pair is unrestricted.

### The Waterfall — 15 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Cards 1 through 9 of one suit, plus a Pair of Honors of that same suit.

**1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · Q♣ Q♣**

All nine numbered cards and the Queen Pair are Clubs.

### The Nine Gates — 15 pts · O/C · +1 if closed

Only one suit, with the strict pattern 11234567899.

**1♥ 1♥ 2♥ · 3♥ 4♥ 5♥ · 6♥ 7♥ 8♥ · 9♥ 9♥**

Exceptional Hand: two 1s, two 9s and one card of each number from 2 to 8.

# KAMI V6 — THE KEYS

## Mythic Keys — Examples and Special Cases

Four Winning Hands illustrate the Grand Keys, their unusual forms and the rules for stacking.

### Example 1 — The Great Wanderer: Three Jack Triplets

**J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 5♥ 5♥**

Open Hand; the second 5♥ is captured (“Thank you!”). Each suit has a Jack Triplet.

**Calculation:** The Great Wanderer 10 pts

**TOTAL: 10 points**

The Little Wanderer is included and does not score. Indicator: 4♦ → Trump Card 5♦, absent.

---

### Example 2 — The Elders’ Circle: Exceptional Hand

**Q♣ Q♣ · J♣ · 1♥ · 9♥ · 1♦ · 9♦ · Q♥ · J♥ · 1♣ · 9♣**

Closed Hand; the second Q♣ is drawn (“Served!”). Ten different cards among the twelve Terminals and Honors, plus one duplicate.

**Calculation:** The Elders’ Circle 10 pts + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 11 points**

No Closed Hand bonus for this C-only Key. Indicator: 4♦ → Trump Card 5♦, absent.

---

### Example 3 — The Waterfall: Honor Pair of the Same Suit

**1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · Q♣ Q♣**

Closed Hand; the second Q♣ is drawn (“Served!”). Cards 1 through 9 and the Queen Pair are all Clubs.

**Calculation:** The Waterfall 15 pts + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 17 points**

The Great Road is included and does not score. Indicator: 7♦ → Trump Card 8♦, absent.

---

### Example 4 — The Nine Gates: Strict Pattern

**1♥ 1♥ 2♥ · 3♥ 4♥ 5♥ · 6♥ 7♥ 8♥ · 9♥ 9♥**

Closed Hand; the second 9♥ is drawn (“Served!”). The Hand follows exactly 11234567899, entirely in Hearts.

**Calculation:** The Nine Gates 15 pts + Closed Hand bonus 1 pt + The Good Fairy 1 pt

**TOTAL: 17 points**

The Heart Key is included. Exceptional Hand, without the usual meld-and-Pair structure. Indicator: 7♦ → Trump Card 8♦, absent.

**Reminder:** A Key contained within a stronger Key does not score again. A C-only Key receives no Closed Hand bonus.

The Secrets of the Kami Forest
In the Kami Forest, the trees whisper stories that only attentive travelers can truly hear...
Angelino watches over the forest, accompanied by the Kodama, small woodland spirits.
Did he see us?
Shhh!
The Guardians protect the paths leading to the Great Keys.
The Vagabonds, for their part, travel the forest paths, in search of encounters and adventures.

In the Forest of Kami, chance encounters often lead to a game of cards...
Your turn, Chatdalf!
Hmm... That really complicates things...
Sometimes, the Good Fairy gives the Kamishis a little help...

When the Forest of Kami falls asleep, a small light continues to shine among the trees...
Chatdalf's Workshop
What if we desigined a new KEY?
As long as it's fun to discover!
Chatdalf... you did remove the Spade cards, right?
Oops...

# KAMI — KEY REFERENCE

KEY STACKING · Keys can be combined. If a Key is contained in a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.
Example: The Long Path includes The Little Path. Only The Long Path scores.

O/C: open or closed · C: closed only · O: open only · +1 if closed, except Stream and Little Pebbles · Starting points: Common 10 · Uncommon 15 · Rare 20 · Mythic 25

## COMMON

### The Good Fairy — 1 pt · C
Draw the winning card.
2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 7♦ 7♦ 7♦ · 9♥ 9♥ (drawn)

### The Little Pebbles — 1 pt · O/C
Triplet of Queens, Turn Jack or Position. Eligible Triplets stack; no closed bonus.
Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · 2♣ 3♣ 4♣ · 6♦ 7♦ 8♦ · 5♥ 5♥

### The Stream — 1 pt · O/C
Only numbered cards 2 to 8. No closed bonus.
2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 5♦ 6♦ 7♦ · 2♥ 2♥

### The Little Path — 1 pt · O/C · +1 if closed
Two identical Sequences.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 4♦ 4♦ 4♦ · J♣ J♣

### The Two Oaks — 1 pt · O/C · +1 if closed
Two Triplets of the same number in different suits.
3♥ 3♥ 3♥ · 3♣ 3♣ 3♣ · 4♦ 5♦ 6♦ · J♣ J♣

### The Kami — 2 pts · C
Declare Kami while Waiting and stake 1 pt. At least one winning card must be absent from all discards.

### The Grove of Oaks — 2 pts · O
Three Triplets and a Pair.
2♥ 2♥ 2♥ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · J♥ J♥

## UNCOMMON

### The River — 1 pt · C
Sequences only, two-sided wait and ordinary Pair.
In Hand: 2♥ 3♥ → waiting for 1♥ or 4♥

### The Two Maples — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Two concealed Triplets; the rest may be open.
3♥ 3♥ 3♥ · 7♣ 7♣ 7♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 9♥ 9♥

### The Forest Edge — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Every Sequence, Triplet and Pair contains a Terminal or Honor.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · 9♣ 9♣

### The Clearing — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
All numbered cards of one suit; Honors of any suit.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 7♥ 8♥ 9♥ · Q♦ Q♦ Q♦ · 5♥ 5♥

### The Echoes — 3 pts · C
Five Pairs plus one matching extra card.
1♥ 1♦ · J♣ J♣ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 9♦ 9♦ · 6♥ 6♥

### The Assembly — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only Terminals or Honors.
1♦ 1♦ 1♦ · 9♣ 9♣ 9♣ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · Q♥ Q♥

### The Winding Path — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
The same Sequence in all three suits.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 4♣ 4♣

### The Long Path — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Two identical Sequences plus the same Sequence in another suit.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 4♣

## RARE

### The Great Road — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Cards 1–9 of one suit, plus any Pair.
1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 4♦ 5♦ 6♦ · 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ · J♣ J♣

### The Little Wanderer — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Two Jack Triplets; the rest unrestricted.
J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 7♥ 7♥

### The Little Guardian — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Two Queen Triplets; the rest unrestricted.
Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · 2♦ 3♦ 4♦ · 7♥ 7♥

### The Heart Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only numbered Hearts, no Honors.
1♥ 2♥ 3♥ · 5♥ 5♥ 5♥ · 7♥ 8♥ 9♥ · 4♥ 4♥

### The Silver Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only numbered Diamonds, no Honors.
1♦ 2♦ 3♦ · 5♦ 5♦ 5♦ · 7♦ 8♦ 9♦ · 4♦ 4♦

### The Earth Key — 5 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only numbered Clubs, no Honors.
1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · 4♣ 4♣

## GRAND KEYS

### The Grove of Maples — 6 pts · C
Three concealed Triplets.
2♥ 2♥ 2♥ · 5♣ 5♣ 5♣ · 8♦ 8♦ 8♦ · J♥ J♥

### The Forest of Kami — 7 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
One Sequence; concealed numbered Triplet; Honor Triplet and Pair of the other Honor (different suits). All three suits.
2♥ 3♥ 4♥ · 5♦ 5♦ 5♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · Q♥ Q♥

## MYTHIC

### The Great Wanderer — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
One Triplet of each Jack.
J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · J♣ J♣ J♣ · 5♥ 5♥

### The Kodama Path — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only 1s and 9s, no Honors.
1♥ 1♥ 1♥ · 9♦ 9♦ 9♦ · 9♣ 9♣ 9♣ · 1♣ 1♣

### The Sanctuary — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Only Honors.
Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · J♥ J♥ J♥ · J♦ J♦ J♦ · Q♥ Q♥

### The Elders' Circle — 10 pts · C
Ten different Terminals/Honors plus one duplicate.
Q♣ Q♣ · J♣ · 1♥ · 9♥ · 1♦ · 9♦ · Q♥ · J♥ · 1♣ · 9♣

### The Great Guardian — 10 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
One Triplet of each Queen.
Q♥ Q♥ Q♥ · Q♦ Q♦ Q♦ · Q♣ Q♣ Q♣ · 5♥ 5♥

### The Waterfall — 15 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
Cards 1–9 of one suit plus Honor Pair of same suit.
1♣ 2♣ 3♣ · 4♣ 5♣ 6♣ · 7♣ 8♣ 9♣ · Q♣ Q♣

### The Nine Gates — 15 pts · O/C · +1 if closed
One suit, strict pattern 11234567899.
1♥ 1♥ 2♥ · 3♥ 4♥ 5♥ · 6♥ 7♥ 8♥ · 9♥ 9♥

**+1 pt per Trump Card in Hand · +1 pt per Under Trump Card when winning after declaring Kami**


# KAMI — KEY REFERENCE

KEY STACKING · Keys can be combined. If a Key is contained in a stronger Key, only the stronger Key scores.
Example: The Long Path includes The Little Path. Only The Long Path scores.

O/C: open or closed · C: closed only · O: open only · +1 if closed, except Stream and Little Pebbles · Starting points: Common 10 · Uncommon 15 · Rare 20 · Mythic 25



**+1 pt per Trump Card in Hand · +1 pt per Under Trump Card when winning after declaring Kami**

# KAMI — QUADS REFERENCE

**ADVANCED VARIANT · QUICK REFERENCE**

## THREE TYPES OF QUAD

Closed Quad · Four identical cards in Hand. Two middle cards face up, two outer cards face down. The Hand remains Closed.

Open Quad · Capture a discard to complete three identical cards. All four cards face up; the Hand becomes Open.

Added Quad · Add the fourth identical card to an exposed Triplet. The Hand remains Open.

## AFTER COMPLETING A QUAD

1. Draw a replacement card from the Dead Leaves Pile.
2. Reveal a new Trump Indicator from the face-down cards.
3. Announce “Servi!” if the Hand wins; otherwise, discard.

## KEY RESTRICTIONS

• Maximum 4 Quads per Round across all Kamishis; at most 3 in one Winning Hand.

• A Quad counts as a Triplet. A Winning Hand with 1, 2 or 3 Quads has 12, 13 or 14 cards.

• After “Kami!”: only a Closed Quad is allowed, without changing the Hand structure or Waiting Cards. If the replacement does not win, discard that same card.

• A Quad may contain at most 1 Joker (standing in for a 5).

• Incompatible with the “Explosive Guardian” variant.

## THREE QUAD KEYS

### THE FOUR-LEAF CLOVER — 2 pts · O/C · +1 if Closed

Win using the replacement card drawn after completing a Quad. Announce “Servi!”.

### THE WINDBLOWN LEAF — 3 pts · O/C · +1 if Closed

Capture the fourth card of an attempted Added Quad to win: “Merci!”. The Quad fails; its declarer pays the Winning Hand. No new Trump Indicator.

### THE GREAT BOUGHS — 15 pts · O/C · +1 if Closed

Complete 3 Quads in one Winning Hand (Closed, Open or Added).

O/C: Open or Closed Hand · +1 pt bonus if Closed

# Kami V6

# Contents

## DISCOVERING KAMI


Game Overview ..... 5
Goal of the Game ..... 6
Components and Setup ..... 7
Dealing the Cards ..... 8


## THE GAME RULES


The Trump and the Hand ..... 9
Turn Sequence ..... 11
Ready Hand and the Mirror ..... 13
Kami ..... 14
Completing Your Hand and Winning the Round ..... 16
Payment of Points ..... 17
Special Cases ..... 18
End of Round and End of Game ..... 19


## THE VARIANTS

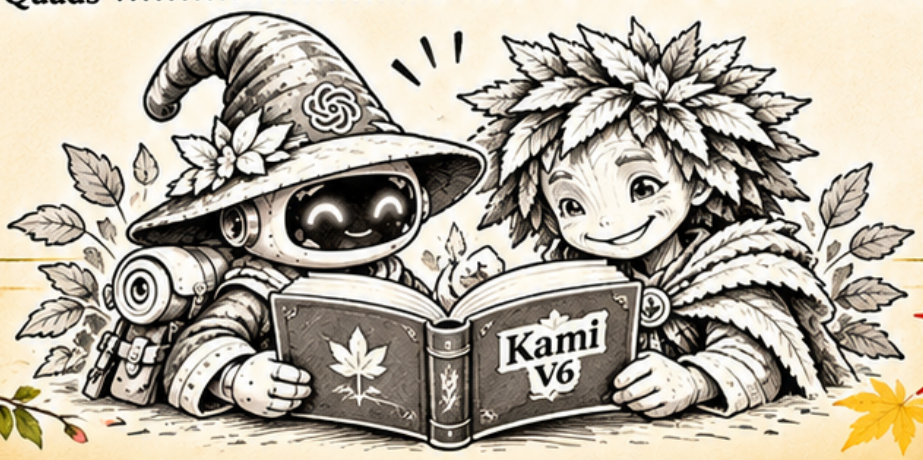

Two-Player Variant ..... 20
Other Variants ..... 21
Advanced Variant — The Quads ..... 22


## THE KEYS


Overview of the Keys ..... 25
Key Categories ..... 27
Common Keys ..... 28
Uncommon Keys ..... 30
Rare Keys ..... 32
Mythical Keys ..... 34


## PLAYER AIDS


List of Keys ..... 39
The Quads ..... 40

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